

What the website needs

A short checklist of the APIs to connect and the accounts or information needed from the business.

Recommended first launch: Quote-first. Customers browse products and send real enquiries or quote requests. Add online checkout only after the business approves payment, stock and fulfilment processes.

1. Product and catalogue API

A basic hosted product API and staff editor already exist. Confirm whether they stay as the production source or connect to another catalogue.

- GET /api/products - published products.
- GET /api/products/:id - one product by stable ID or slug.
- Staff endpoints to create, edit, publish and retire products.
- Product image upload and delivery.
- Separate states for exact price, price on request, in stock, stock on request and unavailable.
- Business input: official product/price/stock source, API or export access, update frequency and publishing approvers.

2. Contact and quote APIs

The current forms are demonstrations and do not send information. These are the main APIs needed for the quote-first launch.

- POST /api/contact - general enquiry.
- POST /api/product-quote - customer, product ID/SKU, quantity and message.
- POST /api/installation-quote - customer, address, products and installation notes.
- Validate on the server, limit spam, save or queue each request, send it to the correct inbox/CRM, confirm receipt to the customer and log delivery failures.

3. Staff access API

The prototype uses the hosting platform's signed-in user plus an email allowlist. Confirm whether that is acceptable for production.

- GET /api/admin/me - return the staff member and role.
- Protect every admin change on the server, not only in the page interface.
- Use at least catalogue editor and administrator roles.
- Record who changed a product, price, stock value or publication state.
- Provide a quick process for removing staff access.

4. Only if online checkout is approved

Do not build these for a quote-first launch: server-validated cart totals, checkout, delivery, payment webhooks, orders, stock reservation, refunds, customer order emails and real customer accounts.

What we need from people and accounts

The backend colleague may already control some of these. For the others, identify the account owner and grant only the access needed.

Accounts and technical access

Hosting account

Production project access, deployment settings and billing owner.
Current setup uses a Worker-style host, D1 database and R2 image storage.

Domain and DNS

Final domain, DNS and SSL/domain verification access.

Product source

Source-system name, API/export credentials, field mapping, update frequency and fallback when it fails.

Database/images

Production database and bucket, staging separation, backup method and restore owner.

Staff login

Identity provider, approved staff, roles and access-removal owner.

Business email

Approved sender, shared enquiry inbox and DNS access for email authentication.

Email service

Transactional email account/API key, verified sending domain and failure alerts.

Optional services

CRM/helpdesk, bot protection and error monitoring, if chosen.

Privacy

Approved privacy notice, consent wording and enquiry retention period.

Business answers

1. Where should the three types of enquiry go?
2. Who replies, and what response time can we promise?
3. Which source wins when price or stock conflicts?
4. Should unknown values become Price/Stock on request?
5. Who can edit products and who can publish them?
6. What delivery, service and installation areas apply?
7. Is launch quote-only, or must it accept payment?

Minimum launch test

- Submit one real contact, product quote and installation quote.
- Confirm each reaches the right inbox/CRM with correct details.
- Confirm the customer receives a reference and acknowledgment.
- Force one delivery failure and confirm staff receive an alert.
- Confirm an unauthorized user cannot change the catalogue.
- Update price/stock and verify the public page changes.
- Restore a database backup successfully.

Simple delivery order

1. Confirm hosting, domain, product source, staff login and email owners.
2. Connect and test the three form APIs.
3. Confirm catalogue API and staff permissions.
4. Add monitoring, backups and privacy text.
5. Launch quote-first; decide on ecommerce later.

First meeting outcome: name the owners, choose the product source and email destination, and agree whether the first release is quote-first.